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## Refresher Course

### 90 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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## Practice Set 1

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### Q1. Fire Triangle Fill up the blanks

- A) Fuel
- B) Heat
- C) Oxygen
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: D (All of the above)**

### Q2. Class A involves flammable liquids. True or False?

- A) True
- B) False

**Correct Answer: B (False)**

### Q3. What is the minimum capacity of emergency fire pumps in meter cube per hour?

- A) 15 meter cube per hour
- B) 20 meter cube per hour
- C) 25 meter cube per hour
- D) 30 meter cube per hour

**Correct Answer: C (25 meter cube per hour)**

### Q4. What is the best fire extinguisher for electrical fires?

- A) CO2
- B) Foam
- C) Water
- D) DCP

**Correct Answer: A (CO2)**

### Q5. What is the color of light used for smaller boats?

- A) Green
- B) Yellow
- C) White
- D) Blue

**Correct Answer: C (White)**



- A) Hyper mist
- B) CO2
- C) DCP
- D) Foam

**Correct Answer: A (Hyper mist)**

**Q7. How many hours should a diesel-driven fire pump run?**

- A) 12 hours
- B) 14 hours
- C) 16 hours
- D) 18 hours

**Correct Answer: D (18 hours)**

**Q8. Dry chemical powder extinguisher works on what principle?**

- A) Smothering
- B) Starvation
- C) Inhibition
- D) Cooling

**Correct Answer: C (Inhibition)**

**Q9. Class B bulkheads are classified as B15 and B0. True or False?**

- A) True
- B) False

**Correct Answer: A (True)**

**Q10. Maximum temperature of the unexposed side of a B class division:**

- A) 300 degrees centigrade
- B) 350 degrees centigrade
- C) 400 degrees centigrade
- D) 250 degrees centigrade

**Correct Answer: D (250 degrees centigrade)**

**Q11. DCP firefighting system is used in which types of vessels?**

- A) Oil tankers
- B) Chemical tankers
- C) Bulk carriers
- D) Gas carriers

**Correct Answer: D (Gas carriers)**



- A) 16 kgs
- B) 25 kgs
- C) 12 kgs
- D) 23 kgs

**Correct Answer: D (23 kgs)**

**Q13. Class A fire extinguisher is best used on:**

- A) Solids
- B) Liquids
- C) Gases
- D) Metals

**Correct Answer: A (Solids)**

**Q14. In which language is the fire control plan written on board?**

- A) French
- B) English
- C) Spanish
- D) Any local language

**Correct Answer: B (English)**

**Q15. Automatic CO2 release system is for which space?**

- A) Accommodation
- B) Main deck
- C) Engine room
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: D (None of the above)**

**Q16. How often should rescue boards be launched with their assigned crew and manning water?**

- A) Every month
- B) Every week
- C) Once in three months
- D) Once in two weeks

**Correct Answer: C (Once in three months)**

**Q17. Your vessel is in collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking. How will you handle the situation?**

- A) Search for missing persons, monitor the situation, prepare for abandonment if required.
- B) Leave the vessel and stay close by.
- C) Wait and see the situation.
- D) Ensure the lifeboat has enough fuel to reach land.

**Correct Answer: A (Search for missing persons, monitor the situation, prepare for abandonment if required.)**

Q18. The visible range of parachute flares at nighttime is:



- A) 8 nautical miles
- B) 10 nautical miles
- C) 15 nautical miles
- D) 25 nautical miles

**Correct Answer: D (25 nautical miles)**

Q19. What should be done in case of a fire on board?

- A) Let the wind follow the fire to reduce oxygen.
- B) Let the stem be up against the wind.
- C) Continue on course and speed.
- D) Reduce speed, keep the fire zone leeward.

**Correct Answer: D (Reduce speed, keep the fire zone leeward.)**

Q20. What is the full form of PASS in portable fire extinguishers?

- A) Pull, Aim, Shut, Sit
- B) Power, Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep
- C) Pass, Aim, Sure, Speed
- D) Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep

**Correct Answer: D (Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep)**

Q21. How should the painter of a life raft, which is fitted with an HRU, be secured to the ship?

- A) Secured via a weak link to a secure point.
- B) Secured to a part of the hydrostatic release unit that is designed to break free.
- C) It should not be secured in any way.
- D) Directly to a secure point on the ship.

**Correct Answer: A (Secured via a weak link to a secure point.)**

Q22. Before lifting a lifeboat from water, it must be ensured that:

- A) The bottom plug is shipped.
- B) Fall wires are clear and looped securely.
- C) The engine is going astern.
- D) The anchor is streamed.

**Correct Answer: B (Fall wires are clear and looped securely.)**

Q23. What is the duration of an emergency escape breathing device (EBD)?

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 8 minutes
- C) 12 minutes
- D) 10 minutes

**Correct Answer: D (10 minutes)**



- A) 20 minutes
- B) 25 minutes
- C) 30 minutes
- D) 45 minutes

**Correct Answer: C (30 minutes)**

**Q25. The extinguisher that can be used for class F or class K fires is:**

- A) CO2
- B) Dry chemical powder
- C) Foam
- D) Wet chemical

**Correct Answer: D (Wet chemical)**

**Q26. Oxygen removal stops fire by:**

- A) Cooling effect
- B) Inhibition
- C) Starvation
- D) Smothering

**Correct Answer: D (Smothering)**

**Q27. What is the fourth component of a fire tetrahedron?**

- A) Molecular chain reaction
- B) Inhibition
- C) Fire reaction
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: A (Molecular chain reaction)**

**Q28. What is the color coding of a portable water extinguisher?**

- A) Cream
- B) Yellow
- C) Blue
- D) Signal red

**Correct Answer: D (Signal red)**

**Q29. Which type of extinguishers are difficult to recharge on board?**

- A) CO2
- B) DCP
- C) Foam
- D) Water

**Correct Answer: A (CO2)**



- A) 10 meters
- B) 50 meters
- C) 20 meters
- D) 30 meters

**Correct Answer: D (30 meters)**

## Practice Set 2

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**Q1. Which dangerous condition should be kept in mind after using a 15-pound CO2 fire extinguisher on a small oil fire on the engine room floor plates?**

- A) Possible suffocation from the CO2 gas.
- B) Forgetting to secure the engine room ventilation system.
- C) CO2 gas being drawn into nearby engine or air compressor intakes.
- D) Rekindling of the fire.

**Correct Answer: D (Rekindling of the fire.)**

**Q2. Which of the listed classes of fire is considered as one involving electrical equipment?**

- A) Class "A"
- B) Class "B"
- C) Class "C"
- D) Class "D"

**Correct Answer: C (Class "C")**

**Q3. Which of the following would be considered a Class "B" fire?**

- A) Electrical fire in a motor
- B) Waste rag fire in the engine room
- C) Oil fire in the engine room bilges
- D) Fire in the main switchboard

**Correct Answer: C (Oil fire in the engine room bilges)**

**Q4. If ignited, which material would be a class B fire?**

- A) Magnesium
- B) Paper
- C) Wood
- D) Diesel Oil

**Correct Answer: D (Diesel Oil)**



- A) Dry chemical
- B) Foam
- C) Water
- D) Carbon dioxide

**Correct Answer: C (Water)**

**Q6. Which extinguishing agent is most effective on a mattress fire?**

- A) CO2
- B) Foam
- C) Dry Chemical
- D) Water

**Correct Answer: D (Water)**

**Q7. The extinguishing agent most effective for combating wood fires is:**

- A) Water
- B) Carbon dioxide
- C) Foam
- D) Dry chemical

**Correct Answer: A (Water)**

**Q8. You are fighting a fire in a watertight compartment using hoses and river water. Stability may be reduced because of:**

- A) Progressive down flooding
- B) Reduction of water in the storage tanks
- C) Increase in free surface which reduces the metacentric height
- D) Reduction of KG to the minimum allowable

**Correct Answer: C (Increase in free surface which reduces the metacentric height)**

**Q9. When used to fight fire, carbon dioxide:**

- A) Is effective if used promptly on an oil fire
- B) Has a greater cooling effect than water
- C) Is lighter than air
- D) Is harmless to cargo and crew

**Correct Answer: A (Is effective if used promptly on an oil fire)**

**Q10. Carbon dioxide as a firefighting agent has which advantage over other agents?**

- A) It causes minimal damage.
- B) It is safer for personnel.
- C) It is cheaper.
- D) It is most effective on a per unit basis.

**Correct Answer: A (It causes minimal damage.)**



- A) Cool the bulkhead around the fire
- B) Remove combustibles from direct exposure
- C) Close all openings to the area
- D) Shut off all electrical power

**Correct Answer: C (Close all openings to the area)**

**Q12. What is NOT a characteristic of carbon dioxide fire-extinguishing agents?**

- A) Effective even if ventilation is not shut down
- B) Will not deteriorate in storage
- C) Non-corrosive
- D) Effective on electrical equipment

**Correct Answer: A (Effective even if ventilation is not shut down)**

**Q13. Foam extinguishes a fire by:**

- A) Destroying the burning materials
- B) Chemical reaction with the burning material
- C) Absorbing the burning material
- D) Smothering the burning material

**Correct Answer: D (Smothering the burning material)**

**Q14. Immediately after a class "B" fire has been extinguished by the use of foam, crewmen should:**

- A) Carefully apply a low velocity fog over the foam blanket
- B) Wade through the foam blanket to evenly distribute the foam
- C) Be careful not to disturb the foam blanket
- D) Sweep the foam blanket overboard and secure firefighting equipment

**Correct Answer: C (Be careful not to disturb the foam blanket)**

**Q15. The most likely location for a liquid cargo fire to occur on a tanker would be:**

- A) In the midships house
- B) At the main deck manifold
- C) At the vent header
- D) In the pump room

**Correct Answer: D (In the pump room)**

**Q16. You should be most concerned about a possible explosion or fire in fuel tanks:**

- A) During fueling when the fuel first strikes the tank bottom
- B) During fueling when the fuel strikes fuel already in the tank
- C) When underway as the fuel is moved by wave action
- D) Shortly after fueling when fuel vapors gather

**Correct Answer: A (During fueling when the fuel first strikes the tank bottom)**



Q17. You have carbon tetrachloride as part of the cargo. If a fire breaks out in the general area, what is the major danger from the carbon tetrachloride?



- A) It will explode if exposed to a flame
- B) Phosgene gas may be formed if it comes in contact with hot metal
- C) It will burn rapidly once ignited
- D) You cannot use water to fight the fire because it will react with the carbon tetrachloride

**Correct Answer: B (Phosgene gas may be formed if it comes in contact with hot metal)**

Q18. Radiation can cause a fire to spread by:

- A) Transmitting the heat of a fire through the ship's metal
- B) Burning liquids flowing into another space
- C) Heated gases flowing through ventilation systems
- D) The transfer of heat across an unobstructed space

**Correct Answer: D (The transfer of heat across an unobstructed space)**

Q19. To prevent the spread of fire by conduction, you should:

- A) Cool the bulkheads around the fire
- B) Remove combustibles from direct exposure
- C) Close all openings to the area
- D) Shut off all electric power

**Correct Answer: A (Cool the bulkheads around the fire)**

Q20. You notice smoke coming from an open laundry room doorway. After activating the fire alarm, which of the following would you do FIRST?

- A) Attempt to determine what is burning.
- B) Acquire the nearest self-contained breathing apparatus.
- C) Break out the nearest fire hose.
- D) Wait for the fire team to arrive and assist as directed.

**Correct Answer: A (Attempt to determine what is burning.)**

Q21. You are on watch at night in port and discover a fire in #1 hatch. Which action should you take FIRST?

- A) Advise the Chief Mate and Master
- B) Release carbon dioxide into the hatch
- C) Sound the general alarm
- D) Lead a fire hose to the hatch

**Correct Answer: C (Sound the general alarm)**

Q22. The spreading of fire as a result of heat being carried through a vessel's ventilation system is an example of heat transfer by:

- A) Conduction
- B) Convection
- C) Radiation

**Correct Answer: B (Convection)**



- A) Gas detector
- B) Fire control plan
- C) Fire and emergency signals
- D) Dry chemical monitor

**Correct Answer: C (Fire and emergency signals)**

**Q24. The high velocity fog tip used with the all-purpose firefighting nozzle should always be:**

- A) Stowed separately in a clip or rack at each fire station
- B) Attached to the all-purpose nozzle by a chain
- C) Coated with heavy grease to prevent corrosion
- D) Painted red to be identified as emergency equipment

**Correct Answer: B (Attached to the all-purpose nozzle by a chain)**

**Q25. The most common and widely used cooling agent used for fighting fires on merchant vessels is:**

- A) Carbon dioxide
- B) Flue gas
- C) Water
- D) Steam smothering

**Correct Answer: C (Water)**

**Q26. The outlet at a fire hydrant may be positioned anywhere from horizontal to pointing:**

- A) 45 degrees upward
- B) Vertically upward
- C) Vertically downward

**Correct Answer: C (Vertically downward)**

**Q27. The primary function(s) of an automatic sprinkler system is(are) to:**

- A) Extinguish the fire which triggers it
- B) Limit the spread of fire and control the amount of heat produced
- C) Protect people in the areas which have sprinkler heads
- D) Alert the crew to the fire

**Correct Answer: B (Limit the spread of fire and control the amount of heat produced)**

**Q28. If a portable carbon dioxide fire extinguisher has been partially discharged, it should be immediately:**

- A) Tagged and restowed properly in its rack
- B) Weighed and the charge loss recorded before being returned to its rack
- C) Given to the chief engineer for recharging
- D) Tagged 'empty' and stowed separately from charged extinguishers

**Correct Answer: D (Tagged 'empty' and stowed separately from charged extinguishers)**



- A) Foam conducts electricity.
- B) To be most effective, foam should be directed at the base of the fire.
- C) Foam is most effective on burning liquids which are flowing.
- D) Foam can ONLY be used to extinguish class A fires.

**Correct Answer: C (Foam is most effective on burning liquids which are flowing.)**

**Q30. Which of the following hazards is associated with fuel oil fires?**

- A) Emission of noxious gases
- B) Reduced fire-fighting effectiveness due to low oxygen content
- C) Emission of highly flammable vapors
- D) Flashover of confined vapor clouds

**Correct Answer: D (Flashover of confined vapor clouds)**

## Practice Set 3

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**Q1. A carbon dioxide fire extinguisher is required to be recharged if the weight loss exceeds what percentage of the weight of the charge?**

- A) One percent
- B) Five percent
- C) Seven percent
- D) Ten percent

**Correct Answer: D (Ten percent)**

**Q2. Fire hydrant valves on a crude oil tanker shall be isolated from the crude oil washing system by**

- A) Spade blanks
- B) Face blanks
- C) Non-return valves
- D) Automatic closing valves

**Correct Answer: A (Spade blanks)**

**Q3. How do you operate a portable CO2 fire extinguisher?**

- A) Point the horn down
- B) Turn the cylinder upside-down
- C) Break the rupture disc
- D) Pull pin, squeeze grip

**Correct Answer: D (Pull pin, squeeze grip)**



- A) Carried by hand to a fire
- B) Carried or rolled to a fire
- C) Recharged in the field
- D) Used on class HB" fires

**Correct Answer: A (Carried by hand to a fire)**

**Q5. Recharging a previously used cartridge-operated dry chemical fire extinguisher is accomplished by**

- A) Authorized fire equipment servicing personnel only
- B) Replacing the propellant cartridge and refilling it with powder
- C) Puncturing the cartridge seal after installation
- D) Recharging the cartridge and refilling it with powder

**Correct Answer: B (Replacing the propellant cartridge and refilling it with powder)**

**Q6. Multiple fire pumps may be used for other purposes provided that one pump is**

- A) On line to the fire main
- B) Kept available for use on the fire main at all times
- C) Capable of being connected to the fire main
- D) Rated at or above 125 psi

**Correct Answer: B (Kept available for use on the fire main at all times)**

**Q7. Fire hoses should always be stowed at the fire main in a manner which will allow**

- A) All sections to be quickly connected
- B) The nozzle end to be run out to the fire
- C) All sections to be quickly drained
- D) The nozzle and fittings to be easily and quickly inspected

**Correct Answer: B (The nozzle end to be run out to the fire)**

**Q8. What is the most vulnerable part of the fire main system?**

- A) The fire pumps
- B) Exposed hard piping
- C) The hydrant valves
- D) The fire hose

**Correct Answer: D (The fire hose)**

**Q9. In what location MUST a duplicate fire control plan be located?**

- A) Gangway
- B) Engine Room
- C) Crew Mess
- D) Chief Mate's Office

**Correct Answer: A (Gangway)**



- A) Posted every 150 feet along the most continuous deck on the vessel
- B) Permanently posted for the guidance of ship's officers
- C) Given to each crew member in booklet form
- D) Translated into three languages: English, French and Spanish

**Correct Answer: B (Permanently posted for the guidance of ship's officers)**

**Q11. The muster list shows each rig hand's muster station, his duties during abandonment, basic instructions, and**

- A) All emergency signals
- B) Instructions for lowering the survival craft
- C) The time each weekly drill will be held
- D) Work schedule

**Correct Answer: A (All emergency signals)**

**Q12. Which of the following statements is true concerning fire hose stations used in the engine room of a tanker or cargo vessel?**

- A) It must be marked in red letters two inches high
- B) National Standard fire hose coupling threads shall be used
- C) In heavy weather, the hose may be removed temporarily from the hydrant

**Correct Answer: B (National Standard fire hose coupling threads shall be used)**

**Q13. A fireman's outfit carried onboard cargo vessels, must have a**

- A) Canister-type gas mask
- B) Fresh-air breathing apparatus
- C) Self-contained breathing apparatus
- D) Combustible gas indicator

**Correct Answer: C (Self-contained breathing apparatus)**

**Q14. The international shore connection**

- A) Allows hook up of firefighting water from shore facilities
- B) Satisfies pollution prevention requirements
- C) Allows emergency use of the fire main for de-ballasting
- D) Permits discharge of waste oil to shore facilities

**Correct Answer: A (Allows hook up of firefighting water from shore facilities)**

**Q15. Automatic fire dampers in ventilation systems are operated by use of**

- A) Heat or smoke detectors
- B) CO2 system pressure switches
- C) Remotely operated valves
- D) Fusible links

**Correct Answer: D (Fusible links)**



- A) Take part
- B) Watch
- C) Go to their quarters
- D) Stay out of the way and do what they want

**Correct Answer: A (Take part)**

**Q17. The locker or space containing the self-contained breathing apparatus must be**

- A) Located in close proximity to the bridge
- B) Equipped with battery powered emergency lighting
- C) Marked "SELF-CONTAINED BREATHING APPARATUS"

**Correct Answer: C (Marked "SELF-CONTAINED BREATHING APPARATUS")**

**Q18. Which type of extinguisher is hard to recharge onboard?**

- A) CO2
- B) DCP
- C) FOAM
- D) WATER TYPE

**Correct Answer: A (CO2)**

**Q19. What is the duration of EEBD?**

- A) 05 mins
- B) 8 mins
- C) 12 mins
- D) 10 mins

**Correct Answer: A (05 mins)**

**Q20. What action should be taken immediately after a fire has been extinguished?**

- A) They are liable to spontaneous combustion
- B) They are not a hazard
- C) They are not a hazard unless ignited
- D) They generate their own oxygen when ignited and difficult to extinguish

**Correct Answer: D (They generate their own oxygen when ignited and difficult to extinguish)**

**Q21. There are two disadvantages to CO2 when used as a total flooding firefighting agent. One of them is extinguishing concentration will not support human life and**

- A) The lack of cooling effect on heated materials
- B) It breaks down under extreme heat to form poisonous gases
- C) It cannot be used in a dead ship situation without electrical power available to CO2 pump
- D) There is no effect on class A fire even in an enclosed space

**Correct Answer: A (The lack of cooling effect on heated materials)**



- A) Smothering the burning material
- B) Chemically absorbing oxygen
- C) Releasing large amount of CO<sub>2</sub>
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: A (Smothering the burning material)**

**Q23. If restricted visibility is encountered in an accommodation fire, you would**

- A) Carry a torch
- B) Stand up straight to keep your head above the smoke
- C) Use a fan to blow the smoke and flames
- D) Rig lifelines to assist a retreat

**Correct Answer: D (Rig lifelines to assist a retreat)**

**Q24. Firefighters should come back from the area**

- A) After 10 mins of firefighting
- B) Upon instruction from another firefighter
- C) Upon hearing the warning sound from SCBA
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: C (Upon hearing the warning sound from SCBA)**

**Q25. In portable fire extinguishers, PASS stands for**

- A) Pass, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep
- B) Pass, Aim, Shut, Sit
- C) Pass, At, Sure, Speed
- D) Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep

**Correct Answer: D (Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep)**

**Q26. The color coding of a portable extinguisher is**

- A) Signal Red
- B) Blue
- C) Black

**Correct Answer: A (Signal Red)**

**Q27. Automatic CO<sub>2</sub> release system is for which space?**

- A) Accommodation
- B) Main Deck
- C) Engine Room
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: C (Engine Room)**

Q28. In which language is the FIRE CONTROL PLAN written onboard?

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- A) French
- B) English
- C) Spanish
- D) Any local language

**Correct Answer: B (English)**

Q29. Class-A fire extinguisher is best used on?

- A) Solids
- B) Liquids
- C) Gas
- D) Metals

**Correct Answer: A (Solids)**

Q30. What is the maximum weight of a portable fire extinguisher?

- A) 16 Kg
- B) 25 Kg
- C) 12 Kg
- D) 23 Kg

**Correct Answer: A (16 Kg)**